Listen and read the following four conversation excerpts. Notice the phrases people use to break the ice in an informal and formal setting. How do you think the conversation will continue?

Informal

Jacob: Hey Daniel, did you see that new programming language? It seems pretty interesting.

Daniel: Yeah, I heard about it. I'm actually thinking of trying it for our next project. What do you think?

Jacob: Actually, it's not as easy as it looks, I recommend you start checking the documentation soon.

Gabrielle: So, how's it going? Any exciting projects on your plate?

Lucy: Not much, just wrapping up this app I worked on for the past month. What about you? Anything cool you're working on these days?

Gabrielle: Actually yeah, I'm designing a new company identity. I'm sure you'll love the new branding.

Formal

Natalya: Good morning, sir. I hope you're doing well. I wanted to discuss the hiring strategy for our software development team. Are you available for a brief discussion?

Robert: Good morning. Yes, I have some time now. What are your thoughts on the hiring strategy?

Natalya: I want to tell you about the results of the internship program. Actually we have many more excellent candidates than we expected.

Natalya: Good afternoon, sir. I wanted to provide you with an update on the recruitment process for the senior software engineer position. We have shortlisted a few strong candidates.

Robert: Thank you for the update. I'm looking forward to reviewing the profiles. Let's set up a meeting at 4:00pm to discuss further.

Natalya: Actually sir, I can see you're already booked for 4:00. What do you think about 4:30?

How would you start a casual conversation in these situations?



1. You and an English native colleague are early for an online meeting.
2. There's a birthday party in the office and you're in line for cake behind the CEO.
3. You're taking the subway in New York and Keanu Reeves sits next to you